

BENCH

1. Passage anchor

> “Soon, we were sitting on a **bench** near the Ferris wheel...”

Passage meaning

bench = a long seat, usually for more than one person

長椅；長凳

Here, the narrator and Kelvin sit on a public bench in the theme park.

Practice

1. We sat on a **bench** and drank lemonade.

我們坐在**長椅**上喝檸檬水。

2. An old man was resting on a park **bench**.

一位老人正在公園**長椅**上休息。

Core meanings of BENCH

2. bench — long seat

= long seat, often made of wood, metal, or stone, for several people

長椅；長凳

Examples

1. She sat down on a wooden **bench**.

她在一張木製**長椅**上坐下。

2. There are several **benches** beside the lake.

湖邊有幾張**長椅**。

This is the exact passage sense.

3. park bench

= bench placed in a park or public outdoor area

公園長椅

Examples

1. They talked on a **park bench**.
他們坐在**公園長椅**上聊天。
2. He left his bag beside the **park bench**.
他把袋子放在**公園長椅**旁。

Sport: substitute players

4. the bench — substitute players

= area where players who are not currently playing sit; by extension, the reserve players themselves

後備席；替補席；後備球員

Examples

1. He started the game on the **bench**.
他比賽開始時坐在**後備席**上。
2. The coach turned to the **bench** in the second half.
教練在下半場開始起用**替補球員**。

Major sports sense.

5. on the bench

= not currently playing; serving as a substitute

坐後備席；作為替補

Examples

1. She spent most of the match **on the bench**.
她大部分比賽時間都在**後備席**上。
2. He was left **on the bench** for the final.
決賽時他被安排在**後備席**。

Verb: remove from play

6. bench — take a player out of the game

= remove a player from active play and make them sit as a substitute

把球員換下；讓球員坐後備席

Examples

1. The coach **benched** him after several mistakes.

教練在他犯了幾次錯後把他**換下場**。

2. She was **benched** for the next game.

她下一場比賽被安排**坐後備席**。

7. bench — keep someone out of action

Figurative extension:

= temporarily remove someone from an active role or assignment

暫停使用；暫時撤下

Examples

1. The company **benched** the project team until funding returned.

公司在資金恢復前暫時**停用那個專案團隊**。

2. He was effectively **benched** after the dispute.

爭議發生後，他實際上被**暫時撤下工作崗位**。

Less common outside sport, but established by extension.

Law / judiciary

8. the bench — judges collectively

= judges, especially considered as a group or institution

法官；司法席位；法官席

Examples

1. The case was heard by a three-judge **bench**.

案件由三名法官組成的**合議庭**審理。

2. The **bench** questioned the lawyer closely.
法官席仔細盤問了律師。

Major formal/legal sense.

9. bench — judge's seat / judicial office

= seat or position occupied by a judge in court
法官席；法官職位

Examples

1. The judge returned to the **bench**.
法官回到**法官席**。
2. She was appointed to the federal **bench**.
她獲任命為聯邦**法官**。

In expressions such as **appointed to the bench**, it means appointment as a judge.

10. bench trial

= trial decided by a judge rather than a jury
法官審理；無陪審團審訊

Examples

1. The defendant chose a **bench trial**.
被告選擇由法官直接審理的**無陪審團審訊**。
2. The case proceeded as a **bench trial**.
案件以**法官審理**方式進行。

Workbench / practical surface

11. bench — work surface

= strong table or work surface used for practical, technical, laboratory, or craft work

****工作檯；工作台****

Examples

1. The tools were spread across the ****bench****.
工具攤放在****工作台****上。
2. He repaired the device at his ****bench****.
他在自己的****工作檯****上修理裝置。

12. workbench

= sturdy table used for manual or technical work

****工作台；工作檯****

Examples

1. The carpenter worked at a wooden ****workbench****.
木匠在木製****工作台****前工作。
2. Keep the tools beside the ****workbench****.
把工具放在****工作檯****旁。

Laboratory sense

13. bench — laboratory work surface

= laboratory table or area where experiments are carried out

****實驗台；實驗工作檯****

Examples

1. The samples were left on the ****lab bench****.
樣本被留在****實驗台****上。
2. She spent the morning working at the ****bench****.
她整個早上都在****實驗台****前工作。

14. bench work

= practical laboratory or technical work done at a bench

****實驗台工作；實作工作****

Examples

1. The role involves both analysis and ****bench work****.

這個職位同時涉及分析和****實驗台實作工作****。

2. He prefers ****bench work**** to administrative tasks.

比起行政工作，他更喜歡****實作工作****。

Scientific testing

15. bench test

= test performed under controlled conditions on a workbench or in a laboratory rather than in real operating conditions

****台架測試；實驗室測試****

Examples

1. The motor passed the ****bench test****.

馬達通過了****台架測試****。

2. Engineers carried out a ****bench test**** before field trials.

工程師在實地測試前先進行****台架測試****。

Useful technical extension.

Geology / landscape

16. bench — flat ledge or terrace

= long, relatively flat strip or ledge of land on a slope or beside a body of water

****階地；平台；岩階****

Examples

1. The trail crossed a narrow rocky ****bench****.

小徑穿過一條狹窄的岩石****平台****。

2. The river had cut a ****bench**** into the valley side.

河流在山谷側面形成了一個**階地**。

Established geological/geographical sense.

Bench in mining

17. bench — level step in a quarry or open-pit mine

= horizontal level or step cut into the side of an excavation

台階；採礦階段平台

Examples

1. Workers moved equipment to the next **bench**.

工人把設備移到下一層**採礦平台**。

2. The mine is developed in a series of **benches**.

礦場以一系列**台階平台**開採。

Specialist but established.

Bench strength

18. bench strength — sport

= quality and depth of substitute players available to a team

後備實力；替補深度

Examples

1. The team has excellent **bench strength**.

這支球隊有很強的**後備實力**。

2. Their **bench strength** helped them late in the match.

他們的**替補深度**在比賽後段發揮了作用。

19. bench strength — business figurative

= number and quality of capable people ready to step into important roles

人才儲備；後備人才實力

Examples

1. The company needs stronger leadership ****bench strength****.
公司需要更強的領導層****人才儲備****。
2. Good succession planning improves ****bench strength****.
良好的接班規劃可以提升****後備人才實力****。

High-value business metaphor.

On the bench — judiciary

20. on the bench — serving as a judge

= holding judicial office

****擔任法官；在司法職位上****

Examples

1. She served ****on the bench**** for twenty years.
她****擔任法官****二十年。
2. He is one of the most experienced judges ****on the bench****.
他是現任****法官中****經驗最豐富的人之一。

Context distinguishes this sharply from sport.

From the bench

21. from the bench

Legal:

= from the judge or judicial position

****由法官席；由法官作出****

Examples

1. The ruling came ****from the bench****.
裁決由****法官當庭作出****。

2. The judge spoke ****from the bench****.

法官在****法官席上****發言。

Bench warrant

22. bench warrant

Legal:

= warrant issued by a judge, often because someone failed to appear in court

****法官簽發的拘捕令；法庭拘捕令****

Examples

1. The judge issued a ****bench warrant****.

法官簽發了一張****拘捕令****。

2. A ****bench warrant**** was issued after he failed to appear.

他沒有出庭後，法院發出了****拘捕令****。

Specialist but established legal compound.

Key contrasts

23. bench vs seat

****seat****

= general place/object for one person to sit

****座位；椅座****

****bench****

= usually long seat for several people

****長椅；長凳****

Compare:

> a seat on the bus

> 巴士上的座位

> a bench in the park

> 公園長椅

24. bench vs chair

****chair****

= seat usually for one person, often with a back

****椅子****

****bench****

= long seat usually for several people

****長椅****

25. bench vs substitute

In sport:

****substitute****

= individual replacement player

****替補球員****

****bench****

= place where substitutes sit, or the substitute group collectively

****後備席 / 替補陣容****

Compare:

> He is a substitute.

> 他是替補球員。

> He is on the bench.

> 他目前坐後備席。

26. bench vs workbench

****bench****

can itself mean a work table in technical contexts.

****workbench****

= explicitly a sturdy table used for practical work

****工作台****

****Workbench**** is clearer in everyday contexts.

27. bench vs desk

desk

= table for reading, writing, office/computer work

書桌 ; 辦公桌

bench

= long seat OR sturdy work surface used for manual/lab work

長椅 / 工作台

Compare:

> office desk

> 辦公桌

> laboratory bench

> 實驗台

Meaning map

The central physical object is:

a long, flat surface

From this develop two different practical directions.

A. Sitting

Passage

park bench

→ **公園長椅**

Then:

Sport

the bench

→ **後備席**

because substitute players sit there.

From this:

> ****bench a player****

> → 把球員換下 / 放到後備席

> ****bench strength****

> → 後備實力 / 人才儲備

B. Working

Workshop

workbench

→ ****工作台****

Laboratory

lab bench

→ ****實驗台****

Testing

bench test

→ ****台架 / 實驗室測試****

A separate institutional extension is:

Judiciary

the bench

→ ****法官 / 法官席 / 司法職位****

And a physical-landform branch is:

Geology

bench

→ ****平坦階地 / 岩階****

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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bench — seat	可供多人坐的長椅 / 長凳
park bench	設於公園或公共戶外空間的長椅
the bench — sport	未上場球員坐的後備席；亦可指替補球員整體
on the bench — sport	作為替補而沒有上場
bench — sport verb	把球員換下 / 安排坐後備席
bench — figurative verb	暫時把某人撤離活躍角色 / 工作
the bench — judiciary	法官群體 / 法官席 / 司法機構
bench — judicial office	法官職位；任職司法機關
bench trial	不設陪審團、由法官直接裁決的審訊
bench — work surface	用於手工、技術工作的堅固工作台
workbench	供手工 / 技術操作使用的工作台
lab bench	實驗室內進行實驗的工作台
bench work	在實驗台 / 工作台進行的實作工作
bench test	在受控環境下進行的台架 / 實驗室測試
bench — geology	山坡、河谷等上的平坦階地 / 岩階
bench — mining	露天礦、採石場中的水平台階平台
bench strength — sport	球隊替補球員的整體質素與深度
bench strength — business	可隨時接任重要職位的後備人才實力
on the bench — legal	擔任法官 / 處於司法職位
from the bench	由法官 / 法官席當庭作出
bench warrant	由法官簽發、常因未出庭而發出的拘捕令

Passage recap

> “Soon, we were sitting on a **bench** near the Ferris wheel...”

Here:

bench = **a long seat, usually for more than one person**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **長椅**

* **長凳**

Natural contextual translation:

不久，我們坐在摩天輪附近的一張長椅上，手裡各拿著一杯檸檬水。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****bench****

= ****a long seat designed for several people****

****長椅；長凳****

The biggest learner splits are:

> ****park bench****

> → 公園****長椅****

> ****sit on the bench — sport****

> → 坐****後備席****

> ****bench a player****

> → 把球員****換下場****

> ****the bench — law****

> → ****法官 / 法官席****

> ****lab bench****

> → ****實驗台****

> ****workbench****

> → ****工作台****

So the passage uses the straightforward ****public-seat**** sense, while sport, law, laboratory work, and technical work produce several highly lexicalized extensions.